ELDERS QUORUM & RELIEF SOCIETY · 25 MIN

Using the Language of Peacemakers

Elder Alfred Kyungu · October 2026 general conference

Weekly 25-minute meeting (since Sept. 6, 2026). Begin and end with prayer, start the discussion quickly, and counsel together during the lesson. There is no separate counseling topic beforehand.

ONE CORE TRUTH

Forgo harsh words; use the language of peacemakers that uplifts and preserves relationships.

0:00–2:00 — **Welcome & prayer · Presidency**

- A simple welcome, then invite someone to give the opening prayer.
- Keep business to what can't wait; no separate counseling topic. Then start right away.

2:00–5:00 — **Open · Teacher**

- Ask: What harsh words do I need to forgo this week — and what peacemaking words will replace them?
- Invite someone to read: “It is a spiritual exercise to identify the language and expressions we need to forgo and then replace them with words and phrases that bring peace wherever we are and at all times.”
- Give a quiet moment to ponder before anyone answers.

5:00–20:00 — **Discuss one core truth · Everyone**

- Q1. Read Proverbs 6:16 together. How does it help us understand this truth about following Jesus Christ?
- Q2. When have you seen this truth at work in your own life or family?
- Optional, about 3 min: Turn to someone nearby and share your answer to Q2, then invite two or three people to share with everyone.
- Q3. What challenges or opportunities in our ward does this speak to? How could we help one another, including through our ministering and in our homes?
- Let members answer one another. Resist answering every question yourself.

20:00–24:00 — **Invite, testify, follow up · Teacher**

- From the talk: Repent of harsh language; choose peacemaking words that uplift, edify and preserve relationships.
- Ask: “What do you feel impressed to do?” Give a minute to write it down privately.
- Bear brief testimony of Jesus Christ and this truth, or invite someone to.
- Next week, open by inviting one or two people to share how it went.

24:00–25:00 — **Closing prayer · Presidency**

- Invite someone to give the closing prayer. End on time.

BEFORE SUNDAY

Elder Alfred Kyungu, General Authority Seventy, spoke about using the language of peacemakers. The invitation to forgo contention by using the language of peacemakers comes from the living Prophet and is a call to discipleship as individuals follow Jesus Christ. It is a spiritual exercise to identify language and expressions to forgo and replace them with words and phrases that bring peace. Remove words that damage relationships — such as “You are useless,” “Just stop talking” or “What is wrong with you?” — which weaken love, diminish respect and damage relationships. Rather than words that escalate anger, disappointment and frustration, choose words that encourage understanding and peace and that strengthen confidence and preserve relationships — such as “Thank you,” “I’m sorry” and “I forgive you.” The true doctrine of Christ has power to change language. He invited Saints to repent of harsh language that has offended friends, leaders, family members and colleagues; to pray for peaceful communication regardless of differences of opinion; and to use language that uplifts, edifies, comforts and brings people together.

- Read the full talk and pray about what your quorum or Relief Society needs from it.
- Share the talk link a few days early so members come having read it.
- Teach one truth well. Meaningful discussion matters more than covering everything.
- Other scriptures the talk cites: Matthew 12:36–37; Ephesians 4:29; Colossians 4:6; Alma 24:19

Timing follows the Church's 25-minute meeting guidance; adapt it as the Spirit directs. Read the full talk at ChurchofJesusChrist.org.